

SECTION 1 — IMPORT-READY SOURCE FILE

AP World History: Modern Free-Response Practice Exam 5

APWH-SAQ5-001

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 2 — Networks of Exchange

Period: c. 1200–1450

Theme: TEC — Technology and Innovation

Historical Reasoning: Mixed Historical Reasoning

Source Type: Secondary text source

Prompt:

Source 1: Historian Sofia Markovic, “Violence and Empire in Mongol Eurasia,” modern historical interpretation, 2018.

“The Mongol conquests devastated many cities, displaced populations, and destroyed older political structures. The creation of Mongol rule should therefore be understood first as a violent military process that disrupted settled societies across Eurasia.”

Source 2: Historian Rashid Karim, “Exchange under the Pax Mongolica,” modern historical interpretation, 2021.

“Although Mongol conquest was often destructive, Mongol rule also created conditions that expanded long-distance exchange. Protected routes, relay stations, diplomatic travel, and the movement of merchants, artisans, and scholars connected regions of Eurasia more intensely than before.”

- (a) Identify one difference between the two historians’ interpretations of Mongol rule.
- (b) Describe one specific historical development that could be used to support one of the interpretations.
- (c) Explain one way Mongol rule affected cultural, technological, or commercial exchange across Eurasia during c. 1200–1450.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a clear difference between the interpretations, such as Source 1 emphasizing destruction and disruption while Source 2 emphasizes integration and expanded exchange.
- (b) 1 point: Describes a relevant development, such as Mongol destruction of cities, conquest of Abbasid Baghdad, use of cavalry armies, protection of Silk Road routes, relay stations, diplomatic missions, merchant privileges, or movement of technologies and skilled workers.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid effect on exchange, such as the spread of gunpowder technologies, printing knowledge, medical knowledge, merchants, diplomats, missionaries, artisans, or disease across connected Eurasian routes.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should recognize both sides of Mongol rule: conquest could be destructive, but empire also created connections across Eurasia. Strong responses should use specific evidence rather than simply saying “the Mongols helped trade.” For part (c), the best answers explain how political control and protected routes affected movement of people, goods, technologies, or ideas.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ5-002

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires

Period: c. 1450–1750

Theme: CDI — Cultural Developments and Interactions

Historical Reasoning: Sourcing / POV / Purpose / Audience

Source Type: Primary text source

Prompt:

Source: Letter from a Safavid court scholar in Isfahan to a provincial judge, 1612. This excerpt is original but modeled on Safavid religious-administrative writing.

“The shah, protector of the true faith, has ordered that sermons name the rightful Imams and that judges instruct the people in proper belief. In towns where older customs remain strong, persuasion should precede punishment, for a household convinced by learning is more stable than one silenced by fear. The Qizilbash warriors have served the dynasty with courage, but the realm also requires scholars, courts, and schools to bind the people to one sacred order.”

(a) Identify the likely purpose of the letter.

(b) Explain how the letter reflects one method used by the Safavid Empire to legitimize rule.

(c) Explain one way the source’s perspective limits its usefulness for understanding all religious groups within the Safavid Empire.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

(a) 1 point: Identifies a plausible purpose, such as instructing a provincial judge to promote Twelver Shiism, strengthen religious conformity, support the shah’s legitimacy, or use religious education to stabilize rule.

(b) 1 point: Explains a relevant Safavid method of legitimation, such as using Shiism as a state religion, linking the shah to religious authority, relying on scholars and judges, building schools, sponsoring sermons, or balancing military elites with religious institutions.

(c) 1 point: Explains a valid limitation, such as the source representing a court scholar rather than Sunni Muslims, Christians, Jews, Sufis, rural communities, merchants, women, or dissenters; or noting that official religious policy may not reflect local practice.

Model Guidance:

A strong response should connect the letter’s purpose to Safavid state-building. The author supports the shah and religious officials, so the source is useful for understanding official ideology but limited for understanding groups outside the court’s preferred religious order. Strong answers should avoid describing Safavid legitimacy as only military or only religious.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-SAQ5-003

Section: SAQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization

Period: c. 1900–present

Theme: GOV — Governance

Historical Reasoning: Contextualization

Source Type: Non-text source

Prompt:

Source: Description of a commemorative postage stamp issued by the government of Nigeria in 1960, the year of independence.

The stamp shows three images arranged around the new national flag: a student holding books, a farmer standing beside cacao trees, and a worker near an oil derrick and railway line. In the background is a domed government building. The caption reads: “Independence and Progress.” The stamp was printed in English and distributed for domestic and international mail.

- (a) Identify one goal of the newly independent state suggested by the described stamp.
- (b) Explain how the stamp reflects one challenge faced by newly independent states after decolonization.
- (c) Explain one way the goals suggested by the stamp were similar to or different from those of another newly independent state in the twentieth century.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 3

- (a) 1 point: Identifies a valid goal, such as national unity, economic development, education, agricultural production, industrial growth, infrastructure expansion, resource extraction, or international recognition.
- (b) 1 point: Explains a relevant postcolonial challenge, such as building national identity across diverse populations, developing infrastructure, managing export resources, expanding education, creating effective government institutions, or reducing dependence on former colonial economies.
- (c) 1 point: Explains a valid similarity or difference with another newly independent state, such as India, Indonesia, Algeria, Ghana, Kenya, Vietnam, or Tanzania, using specific evidence about development planning, education, industry, agriculture, national unity, nonalignment, or resource control.

Model Guidance:

A strong answer should interpret the stamp as a state-sponsored visual message. The government is presenting independence as linked to progress, education, agriculture, industry, and national institutions. Strong responses should connect the image to broader postcolonial challenges rather than treating independence as a single political event with no economic or social consequences.

Expected Points:

3

APWH-DBQ5-001

Section: DBQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 4 — Transoceanic Interconnections

Period: c. 1450–1750

Theme: ECN — Economic Systems

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Seven-document set

Prompt:

Evaluate the extent to which global silver flows transformed state finance and commercial practices in the period from c. 1550 to 1700.

Document 1

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Report from a Spanish royal mining official to the Council of the Indies, 1578, Potosí.

Source Type: Government report.

“The mountain continues to yield great quantities of silver, but only through strict organization of labor, mercury supply, and royal inspection. The king’s fifth must be collected without delay, for the defense of the monarchy depends upon these revenues. Mine owners complain of labor shortages, yet without regular drafts from nearby provinces the furnaces and mills would fall silent.”

Sourcing cues: Spanish imperial official; emphasizes royal revenue, labor control, and administrative needs.

Document 2

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Memorial from a Ming county magistrate to provincial authorities, 1585, Jiangnan region, China.

Source Type: Administrative memorial.

“The people now pay many obligations in silver, but the amount demanded is difficult for poor cultivators when the market price of grain falls. Merchants obtain silver more easily than peasants, and tax collection becomes uncertain when coinage is scarce. A policy intended to simplify revenue has made local officials dependent on the movement of silver through trade.”

Sourcing cues: Local official in a commercialized region of Ming China; focuses on taxation and social effects of silver demand.

Document 3

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Commercial summary compiled by a Portuguese merchant house, 1600–1640, Macao.

Source Type: Plain-text data table.

Selected Silver and Commodity Exchanges, c. 1600–1640

Source of Silver Common Destination or Use Goods Often Purchased

Spanish American mines Asian markets through merchants Silk, porcelain, spices, luxury goods

Japanese mines Chinese and Southeast Asian trade Silk, cotton goods, medicines

European merchants Indian Ocean and South China Sea ports Textiles, pepper, tea, ceramics

Chinese tax markets Domestic revenue payments Grain, land taxes, commercial debts

Note on the table: Merchants reported that silver was often more profitable in Asian markets where demand for it was high.

Sourcing cues: Merchant-house perspective; emphasizes commercial opportunities and exchange patterns.

Document 4

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Letter from an Ottoman treasury scribe to a provincial governor, 1603,

Istanbul.

Source Type: Administrative letter.

“Prices rise faster than salaries, and soldiers complain that their pay buys less each month. Foreign silver coins pass through markets, but not always at the value officials declare. Tax farmers seek profit in confusion, while villagers ask why old dues now demand new money. The treasury requires revenue, but disorder in coin and price weakens obedience.”

Sourcing cues: Ottoman fiscal official; reveals concerns about inflation, coinage, soldiers’ pay, and tax collection.

Document 5

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Account book note by a Mughal port official, 1632, Surat.

Source Type: Port record.

“Ships arriving from the Red Sea and Southeast Asia bring silver coin in payment for cotton cloth, indigo, and other goods. Merchants prefer reliable silver because it can be used in many ports and converted for local payments. The customs house benefits when trade is active, but disputes arise when coins are clipped, mixed, or valued differently by money changers.”

Sourcing cues: Port official in a major Indian Ocean trading city; emphasizes customs revenue and practical commercial exchange.

Document 6

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Description of a silver coin recovered from a shipwreck in the South China Sea, coin minted in Spanish America, late sixteenth century.

Source Type: Described material object.

The coin is round but irregularly edged, with a stamped royal shield on one side and a cross on the other. Chinese merchant marks have been cut into the surface to test or certify the silver content. The coin was found among ceramic fragments, pepper containers, and trade weights from several Asian ports.

Sourcing cues: Material evidence of long-distance circulation; shows that silver objects could be adapted and verified by merchants outside their place of minting.

Document 7

Author/Origin/Year/Place: Testimony by an Andean community representative before a colonial inspector, 1647, Upper Peru.

Source Type: Legal testimony.

“Our people are counted for mine labor more often than our fields can bear. Men travel to the mountain and return sick or indebted, while women and elders must tend crops and animals with fewer hands. Officials say the silver serves the king and the faith, but our villages carry the weight of the mountain.”

Sourcing cues: Indigenous community perspective; highlights social and labor costs of silver production.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 7

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which global silver flows transformed state finance and commercial practices from c. 1550 to 1700. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning, such as arguing that silver reshaped taxation, imperial revenue, and long-distance trade while also creating inflation, labor coercion, and regional inequalities.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader historical context relevant to global silver flows, such as European maritime expansion, Spanish colonization of the Americas, the growth of transoceanic trade, Ming monetization, Indian Ocean commerce, the Columbian Exchange, mercantilism, or early modern imperial competition.

Evidence from the Documents — 2 points: Earns 1 point by accurately using the content of at least three documents to address the prompt. Earns 2 points by using at least six documents to support an argument about state revenue, tax collection, merchant exchange, Asian demand for silver, inflation, coin circulation, labor systems, or social costs.

Evidence Beyond the Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by using at least one specific piece of relevant outside evidence not found in the documents, such as the Manila galleons, the single-whip tax system, Tokugawa silver mining, mercantilist policies, the mita system, Potosí, Zacatecas, European price revolution, or joint-stock trading companies.

Sourcing / Analysis of Documents — 1 point: Earns the point by explaining how or why the point of view, purpose, audience, or historical situation of at least three documents is relevant to the argument. Effective examples include explaining why Spanish officials emphasized royal revenue, why Ming magistrates focused on tax burdens, why merchants highlighted profits, why Ottoman officials worried about inflation, or why Andean testimony emphasized coerced labor and village hardship.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a more complex understanding of global silver flows. This may include explaining that silver connected distant economies while producing different effects in different regions, distinguishing state fiscal benefits from social costs, or showing how commercial practices changed without eliminating older local systems of labor, taxation, and exchange.

Model Guidance:

A strong DBQ could argue that silver transformed early modern state finance and commerce by becoming central to taxation, imperial revenue, customs collection, and long-distance trade, especially between the Americas, Europe, and Asia. Documents 1, 2, 4, and 5 can support arguments about state finance and taxation. Documents 3 and 6 can support arguments about commercial circulation and merchant practices. Document 7 highlights the labor costs behind silver production. Outside evidence could include the Manila galleons, the single-whip tax, Potosí, Zacatecas, the mita system, or the price revolution. Strong sourcing might compare the priorities of imperial officials, merchants, local magistrates, fiscal administrators, and Indigenous communities.

Expected Points:

7

APWH-LEQ5-001

Section: LEQ

Type: written

Unit: Unit 5 — Revolutions

Period: c. 1750–1900

Theme: TEC — Technology and Innovation

Historical Reasoning: Causation

Source Type: Broad historical prompt with introductory statement

Prompt:

From c. 1750 to 1900, revolutionary ideas spread through pamphlets, newspapers, books, schools, salons, religious networks, postal systems, railways, and telegraphs. These communication systems

did not cause revolutions by themselves, but they shaped how political ideas reached broader audiences.

Evaluate the extent to which changes in communication and print culture contributed to revolutionary movements in the period c. 1750 to 1900.

Scoring Guide:

Total Points: 6

Thesis / Claim — 1 point: Earns the point by making a historically defensible claim that evaluates the extent to which communication and print culture contributed to revolutionary movements from c. 1750 to 1900. A strong thesis should establish a line of reasoning that weighs communication changes against other causes such as social inequality, economic crisis, imperial rule, war, Enlightenment ideas, or state weakness.

Contextualization — 1 point: Earns the point by describing a broader context relevant to revolutionary movements, such as Enlightenment thought, Atlantic revolutions, expanding literacy, urbanization, industrialization, imperial crisis, missionary education, liberalism, nationalism, or the growth of public political debate.

Evidence — 2 points: Earns 1 point by identifying at least two specific pieces of relevant evidence, such as pamphlets in the French Revolution, newspapers in Latin American independence movements, abolitionist print networks, revolutionary clubs, the spread of Enlightenment texts, railways and telegraphs in 1848 revolutions, printed reform literature, or educated elites using newspapers and journals. Earns 2 points by using at least two pieces of evidence to support an argument about causation.

Historical Reasoning — 1 point: Earns the point by using causation to explain how communication and print culture contributed to revolutionary movements. Strong responses might explain that print spread shared grievances, created imagined political communities, criticized authority, coordinated protest, or circulated new concepts of rights and sovereignty, while also recognizing that communication technologies interacted with deeper social, economic, and political causes.

Complexity — 1 point: Earns the point by demonstrating a nuanced understanding of revolutionary causation. This may include explaining that print culture helped mobilize some groups more than others, that communication could spread both radical and conservative ideas, that states also used censorship and propaganda, or that communication networks accelerated revolutions without being sufficient to cause them alone.

Model Guidance:

A strong LEQ should not argue that newspapers or pamphlets alone caused revolutions. Instead, it should explain how communication systems helped spread ideas, coordinate movements, and create political communities while also evaluating other causes. Useful evidence might include French revolutionary pamphlets, Enlightenment texts, Latin American newspapers, abolitionist publications, the revolutions of 1848, telegraph and railway networks, schools, salons, or reform journals. Strong answers should connect communication to causation, not simply list technologies.

Expected Points:

6

SECTION 2 — SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — DO NOT IMPORT

SERIES DO-NOT-REPEAT BANK UPDATE — APWH-FRQ5

· APWH-SAQ5-001: Unit 2 — Networks of Exchange; c. 1200–1450; Mongol Eurasia across Central Asia, China, Persia, Russia, and broader Silk Road zones; secondary text source with two modern historians; source perspectives contrast violence, destruction, and disruption of older political structures with Pax Mongolica exchange, protected routes, relay stations, diplomacy, and movement of merchants/artisans/scholars; historical development is Mongol conquest and

intensified Eurasian exchange; reasoning path weighs disruption versus integration and connects political control to cultural, technological, and commercial exchange; misconception targeted: Mongol rule was only destructive or only beneficial for trade.

· APWH-SAQ5-002: Unit 3 — Land-Based Empires; c. 1450–1750; Safavid Iran / Isfahan and provincial administration; primary text source is an original court-scholar letter to a provincial judge; source perspective is pro-Safavid religious-administrative authority promoting Twelver Shiism, sermons, judges, schools, and balance between Qizilbash military elites and scholars; historical development is Safavid legitimation through Shiism and religious institutions; reasoning path focuses on purpose, state legitimation, and limitations for understanding religious diversity; misconception targeted: Safavid power rested only on military elites or that official religious policy reflects all subjects' experiences.

· APWH-SAQ5-003: Unit 8 — Cold War and Decolonization; c. 1900–present; Nigeria at independence with possible comparison to India, Indonesia, Algeria, Ghana, Kenya, Vietnam, or Tanzania; non-text source type is a described commemorative postage stamp; visual/data/map pattern includes national flag, student, cacao farmer, oil derrick, railway, government building, and “Independence and Progress” caption; historical development is postcolonial nation-building, education, agriculture, resource extraction, infrastructure, and international recognition; reasoning path contextualizes independence as political, economic, and social state-building challenge; misconception targeted: decolonization ended with formal independence and did not require postcolonial development or national integration.

· APWH-DBQ5-001: Unit 4 — Transoceanic Interconnections; c. 1450–1750; Spanish America, Ming China, Macao, Ottoman Empire, Mughal India / Surat, South China Sea, Andean communities, and broader global silver networks; DBQ topic is global silver flows transforming state finance and commercial practices from c. 1550 to 1700; document types include Spanish mining official report, Ming magistrate memorial, merchant-house exchange table, Ottoman treasury letter, Mughal port record, described shipwreck silver coin/material object, and Andean legal testimony; document perspectives include imperial revenue officials, local tax administrators, merchants, fiscal scribes, port officials, material evidence of merchant certification, and Indigenous labor communities; main argument paths include royal revenue, silver taxation, Asian demand, merchant exchange, customs revenue, inflation, coin valuation, labor coercion, and uneven regional effects; outside evidence possibilities include Manila galleons, single-whip tax system, Tokugawa silver mining, mercantilism, mita system, Potosí, Zacatecas, European price revolution, and joint-stock companies; sourcing opportunities include Spanish fiscal priorities, Ming local administrative concerns, merchant profit motive, Ottoman inflation concerns, Mughal customs perspective, material circulation evidence, and Indigenous testimony on labor burdens.

· APWH-LEQ5-001: Unit 5 — Revolutions; c. 1750–1900; transregional evidence from France, Latin America, Atlantic abolition networks, Europe in 1848, reform movements, schools, salons, religious networks, newspapers, railways, postal systems, and telegraphs; LEQ topic is communication and print culture contributing to revolutionary movements; historical reasoning process is causation; evidence categories include French revolutionary pamphlets, Enlightenment texts, Latin American newspapers, abolitionist print networks, revolutionary clubs, salons, railways and telegraphs in 1848, missionary or secular schools, reform journals, censorship, and propaganda; complexity path weighs communication and print against social inequality, economic crisis, imperial rule, war, state weakness, Enlightenment ideas, and nationalism while noting that communication spread both radical and conservative ideas; misconception targeted: communication technologies alone caused revolutions or played no meaningful role in revolutionary mobilization.